

Absolutely — **masterpiece** is worth a full treatment because your passage uses it in a deliberately understated, almost humorous way:

> “The video itself was hardly a **masterpiece**.”

Here **masterpiece** means **an exceptionally excellent work of art or creation** — and the writer says the video was **hardly** one, meaning it was **definitely not** some brilliant artistic achievement.

Word family: **masterpiece**

Base word: masterpiece

Part of speech: noun (名詞)

Major domains: art, literature, music, film, architecture, craftsmanship, engineering/design, figurative praise, ironic/negative understatement

Unlike many earlier words, **masterpiece** itself has relatively few true lexical senses. The richness comes more from:

- * domain transfer
- * figurative extension
- * ironic use
- * fixed evaluative constructions

So this is a word where we should be exhaustive **without artificially inventing extra meanings**.

Meaning in your passage: **masterpiece = exceptionally excellent creative work — 傑作 ; 傑出作品**

Your sentence:

> “The video itself was hardly a **masterpiece**.”

Here **masterpiece** means:

> **a work of exceptionally high artistic or creative quality.**

繁體中文 :

藝術、創作或設計水平極高、被視為代表性佳作的作品 ; 傑作

But because the sentence says:

> **hardly a masterpiece**

the actual meaning is:

> **the video was far from being an outstanding artistic work**

Natural translation:

> 「那段影片本身其實**談不上甚麼傑作**。」

or:

> 「那段影片本身**遠稱不上是傑作**。」

So here:

> **masterpiece = 極高水準的創作作品，而作者故意否定這個標籤**

A. ARTISTIC MASTERPIECE

1. **masterpiece = exceptionally great work of art — 藝術傑作**

The core modern sense.

Practice 1

> “The painting is widely regarded as a **masterpiece**.”

「這幅畫被廣泛視為一件**藝術傑作**。」

Practice 2

> “The museum displays several masterpieces.”

「博物館展出多件**傑作**。」

masterpiece = 在藝術品質、技巧、影響力或完成度上極為出色的作品

B. LITERARY MASTERPIECE

2. **masterpiece = outstanding work of literature — 文學傑作**

Practice 3

> “The novel is considered a literary **masterpiece**.”

「這本小說被視為一部**文學傑作**。」

Practice 4

> “Critics often describe the book as his masterpiece.”

「評論家經常把這本書稱為他的**代表作 / 傑作**。」

literary masterpiece = 文學價值極高、常被視為作者最重要作品之一的作品

C. MUSICAL MASTERPIECE

3. masterpiece = outstanding musical composition — **音樂傑作**

Practice 5

> “The symphony is a musical **masterpiece**.”

「這首交響曲是一部**音樂傑作**。」

Practice 6

> “The album is often called a modern masterpiece.”

「這張專輯常被稱為一部**現代音樂傑作**。」

D. FILM / CINEMA

4. masterpiece = exceptionally excellent film — **電影傑作；影史佳作**

Practice 7

> “Many viewers regard the film as a **masterpiece**.”

「很多觀眾把這部電影視為**傑作**。」

Practice 8

> “The director’s latest film is being hailed as a masterpiece.”

「這位導演的新作被盛讚為一部**傑作**。」

E. ARCHITECTURE

5. **masterpiece = outstanding architectural work — 建築傑作**

Practice 9

> “The cathedral is an architectural **masterpiece**.”

「這座大教堂是一項**建築傑作**。」

Practice 10

> “The building is considered a masterpiece of modern architecture.”

「這棟建築被視為現代建築的**傑作**。」

F. SCULPTURE / DESIGN / CRAFT

6. **masterpiece = exceptionally skillful crafted object — 工藝傑作；精湛作品**

Practice 11

> “The carved cabinet is a masterpiece of craftsmanship.”

「這個雕刻櫃是一件**工藝傑作**。」

Practice 12

> “The watch is a masterpiece of precision engineering.”

「這枚手錶是精密工程的**傑作**。」

masterpiece = 不限於純藝術，也可指工藝、設計、製造極其出色的成果

G. “A MASTERPIECE OF...”

7. **a masterpiece of + field/quality =方面的傑作 / 極致成果**

A very productive construction.

Practice 13

> “The building is a **masterpiece of engineering**.”

「這棟建築是**工程技術的傑作**。」

Practice 14

> “The speech was a masterpiece of political rhetoric.”

「那場演說是**修辭技巧的傑作**。」

a masterpiece of X = 在 X 方面做到極高水準的成果

H. AUTHOR'S / ARTIST'S BEST WORK

8. someone's masterpiece = 某人的代表作 / 最高成就作品

A major evaluative use.

Practice 15

> “Many consider this novel to be her **masterpiece**.”

「很多人認為這本小說是她的**代表作 / 最高傑作**。」

Practice 16

> “The painting became the artist's masterpiece.”

「這幅畫成了這位藝術家的**代表作**。」

Important distinction:

> **a masterpiece**

> = 一件傑作

> **someone's masterpiece**

> = 常暗示其最重要 / 最高成就之一，甚至最高成就

I. REPRESENTATIVE WORK VS MASTERPIECE

9. **masterpiece can imply more than “representative work”**

This distinction matters.

representative work

= 能代表作者風格的作品

masterpiece

= 品質極高、通常被認為是最優秀作品之一

So:

> 代表作 ≠ automatically 傑作

A work can represent an artist well without being their best.

J. FIGURATIVE MASTERPIECE — PLAN / STRATEGY / PERFORMANCE

10. **masterpiece = exceptionally clever or successful creation/action — 高明之作；傑出成果**

A figurative extension beyond traditional art.

Practice 17

> “The campaign was a marketing **masterpiece**.”

「這項宣傳活動是一次**行銷上的高明之作**。」

Practice 18

> “The operation was a masterpiece of planning.”

「這次行動是**規劃上的傑作**。」

masterpiece — figurative = 某計劃、策略、安排等做得極其出色

K. BUSINESS / STRATEGY

11. **a masterpiece of strategy = 策略傑作；極高明策略**

Practice 19

> “The negotiation was a **masterpiece of strategy**.”

「這場談判是一次**策略上的高明之作**。」

Practice 20

> “The launch was a masterpiece of timing.”

「這次推出在時機掌握上堪稱**傑作**。」

L. ENGINEERING

12. **engineering masterpiece = 工程傑作**

Practice 21

> “The bridge is an **engineering masterpiece**.”

「這座橋是一項**工程傑作**。」

Practice 22

> “The machine is a masterpiece of mechanical design.”

「這台機器是機械設計上的**傑作**。」

M. CULINARY USE

13. **masterpiece = exceptionally impressive dish — 烹飪傑作；佳餚傑作**

Figurative but common enough.

Practice 23

> “The dessert was a culinary **masterpiece**.”

「這道甜品是一件**烹飪傑作**。」

Practice 24

> “The chef created a masterpiece from simple ingredients.”

「廚師用簡單食材創作出一道**傑作級菜式**。」

N. FASHION / DESIGN

14. **design masterpiece = 設計傑作**

Practice 25

> “The chair is considered a design **masterpiece**.”

「這張椅子被視為**設計傑作**。」

Practice 26

> “The dress was a masterpiece of tailoring.”

「這條裙是**剪裁工藝的傑作**。」

O. TECHNICAL / SOFTWARE FIGURATIVE USE

15. **masterpiece = exceptionally elegant technical creation — 技術上的傑作**

Possible in computing/engineering praise.

Practice 27

> “The algorithm is a masterpiece of efficiency.”

「這個演算法堪稱**效率設計上的傑作**。」

Practice 28

> “The codebase is not a masterpiece, but it works.”

「這套程式碼談不上甚麼**傑作**，但確實能運作。」

This is figurative rather than a separate dictionary sense.

P. IRONIC / SARCASTIC USE

16. **masterpiece = used sarcastically for something badly done — 「傑作」；好一個「傑作」
**

A very important pragmatic extension.

Practice 29

> “Well, this broken schedule is a real **masterpiece**.”

「嗯，這份亂七八糟的時間表真是個『**傑作**』。」

Practice 30

> “Your masterpiece has crashed the whole system.”

「你這個『**傑作**』把整個系統搞垮了。」

Here **masterpiece** means the opposite through sarcasm.

Q. “HARDLY A MASTERPIECE”

17. **hardly a masterpiece = 遠稱不上傑作；談不上甚麼傑作**

This is your exact construction.

Practice 31

> “The video was **hardly a masterpiece**.”

「那段影片**遠稱不上甚麼傑作**。」

Practice 32

> “The essay is readable, but hardly a masterpiece.”

「這篇文章算是可讀，但**談不上是傑作**。」

****hardly a masterpiece = 明確表示某作品並不特別出色****

Tone:

- * understated
- * often humorous
- * self-deprecating

R. “NO MASTERPIECE”

18. **no masterpiece = 並非傑作；普通之作**

Practice 33

> “The film is **no masterpiece**, but it is entertaining.”

「這部電影**算不上傑作**，但很有娛樂性。」

Practice 34

> “The design is no masterpiece, yet it is practical.”

「這個設計**不是甚麼傑作**，但很實用。」

S. “NOT EXACTLY A MASTERPIECE”

19. **not exactly a masterpiece = 不算甚麼傑作；談不上出色**

Practice 35

> “My first attempt was **not exactly a masterpiece**.”

「我第一次嘗試**實在談不上甚麼傑作**。」

Practice 36

> “The presentation was not exactly a masterpiece.”

「那場簡報**並不算出色**。」

A very common understated negative construction.

T. “MINOR MASTERPIECE”

20. **minor masterpiece = 小型傑作；較小規模但極出色的作品**

Practice 37

> “The short story is a **minor masterpiece**.”

「這篇短篇小說是一部**小而精緻的傑作**。」

Practice 38

> “Critics described the film as a minor masterpiece.”

「評論家把這部電影形容為一部**小品傑作**。」

Important:

Here **minor** does not mean bad.

It means:

* smaller scale

* less central in the creator’s career
while still excellent.

U. “MODERN MASTERPIECE”

21. **modern masterpiece = 現代傑作**

Practice 39

> “The novel is widely regarded as a **modern masterpiece**.”

「這本小說被廣泛視為一部**現代傑作**。」

Practice 40

> “The building has become a modern masterpiece of design.”

「這棟建築已成為現代設計的一項**傑作**。」

V. “UNDISPUTED / ACKNOWLEDGED MASTERPIECE”

22. **acknowledged masterpiece = 公認傑作**

Practice 41

> “The painting is an **acknowledged masterpiece**.”

「這幅畫是一件**公認傑作**。」

Practice 42

> “The novel later became recognised as a masterpiece.”

「這本小說後來被公認為**傑作**。」

W. “LOST MASTERPIECE”

23. **lost masterpiece = 失傳 / 遺失的傑作**

Practice 43

> “The painting was believed to be a **lost masterpiece**.”

「這幅畫曾被認為是一件**失傳傑作**。」

Practice 44

> “Researchers claimed to have rediscovered a lost masterpiece.”

「研究人員聲稱重新發現了一件**遺失的傑作**。」

X. “MASTERPIECE” HISTORICAL SENSE

24. **masterpiece = work submitted by a craftsman to qualify as a master — 師傅資格作品；代表性考核作品**

An important historical sense.

Historically, in some craft/guild traditions, a **masterpiece** was:

> **a work produced to demonstrate that a craftsman had reached master-level skill.**

Practice 45

> “The craftsman produced a **masterpiece** to prove his skill.”

「工匠製作了一件**師傅資格考核作品**來證明技藝。」

Practice 46

> “A successful masterpiece could demonstrate mastery of the craft.”

「成功完成這種**大師資格作品**可以證明工匠已掌握該門技藝。」

This historical sense helps explain the modern meaning:

> exceptional work demonstrating mastery.

Y. MASTERPIECE VS MASTERWORK

25. **masterwork** = 傑作；大師之作

Practice 47

> “The painting is one of his greatest **masterworks**.”

「這幅畫是他最偉大的**傑作之一**。」

Practice 48

> “The building is a masterwork of modern design.”

「這棟建築是現代設計的**傑作**。」

masterwork is close to **masterpiece**, often slightly more formal/literary.

Z. MASTERPIECE VS MAGNUM OPUS

26. **magnum opus** = 畢生代表作；最重要作品

A very useful contrast.

masterpiece

= any exceptionally excellent work.

magnum opus

= creator's greatest/most important major work, often one defining work.

Example:

> "This novel is a masterpiece."

= 這本小說是一部傑作。

> "This novel is widely regarded as her magnum opus."

= 這本小說被廣泛視為她的**畢生代表作**。

Not every masterpiece is someone's magnum opus.

AA. MASTERPIECE VS CLASSIC

27. **masterpiece vs classic**

masterpiece

= exceptionally excellent work.

classic

= work widely recognised over time as important, exemplary, or enduring.

A new film can be:

> a masterpiece

before enough time has passed for it to become:

> a classic.

AB. MASTERPIECE VS WORK OF ART

28. **masterpiece vs work of art**

work of art

= an artwork generally, or figuratively something beautifully made.

masterpiece

= specifically exceptionally excellent.

Every artistic masterpiece is a work of art.

Not every work of art is a masterpiece.

AC. MASTERPIECE VS ARTWORK

29. **masterpiece vs artwork**

artwork

= neutral category term.

masterpiece

= strong evaluative judgement.

> artwork

> = 藝術作品

> masterpiece

> = 傑作

AD. MASTERPIECE VS CREATION

30. **masterpiece vs creation**

creation

= anything created.

masterpiece

= creation judged exceptionally good.

Your passage's video is:

> a creation

but, by the writer's own statement:

> hardly a masterpiece.

This contrast is directly relevant.

AE. MASTERPIECE VS ACHIEVEMENT

31. **masterpiece vs achievement**

achievement

= something successfully accomplished.

masterpiece

= exceptionally excellent creative/productive result.

A difficult engineering project may be an achievement without being called a masterpiece.

AF. MASTERPIECE VS SUCCESS

32. **masterpiece vs success**

success

= achieves desired result.

masterpiece

= judged outstanding in quality.

A film can be:

* commercial success but not masterpiece

* masterpiece but commercial failure

Very important.

AG. MASTERPIECE VS HIT

33. **masterpiece vs hit**

hit

= commercially/popularly successful.

masterpiece

= artistically/qualitatively exceptional.

A viral video can be:

> a hit

without being:

> a masterpiece.

This is exactly your passage.

AH. MASTERPIECE VS VIRAL CONTENT

34. **viral ≠ masterpiece**

You already curated **viral**.

viral

= spreads rapidly online.

masterpiece

= judged to have exceptionally high creative/artistic quality.

Something can go viral because it is:

- * funny
- * relatable
- * shocking
- * strange

* simple

without being artistically exceptional.

This contrast is central to the source sentence.

AI. MASTERPIECE VS POPULAR

35. **popular ≠ masterpiece**

popular

= liked by many people.

masterpiece

= exceptional quality.

Popularity measures audience reception.

Masterpiece is an evaluative quality judgement.

AJ. MASTERPIECE VS FAMOUS

36. **famous work ≠ masterpiece**

famous

= widely known.

masterpiece

= exceptionally excellent.

A work can be famous because it is controversial, historically important, or unusual, not necessarily because it is a masterpiece.

AK. MASTERPIECE VS CELEBRATED WORK

37. **celebrated work vs masterpiece**

celebrated work

= highly praised/well known.

masterpiece

= considered outstanding at the highest level.

Close, but **masterpiece** is stronger.

AL. MASTERPIECE VS BRILLIANT

38. **masterpiece vs brilliant**

brilliant

= extremely clever/excellent.

masterpiece

= noun referring to the resulting outstanding work.

> brilliant film

> = 出色電影

> a masterpiece

> = 傑作

AM. MASTERPIECE VS PERFECT

39. **masterpiece ≠ perfect**

A masterpiece can still contain flaws.

perfect

= without flaws / exactly right.

masterpiece

= exceptionally accomplished and important.

So:

> masterpiece does not literally mean faultless.

AN. MASTERPIECE VS MASTERFUL

40. **masterpiece vs masterful**

masterpiece

noun:

= 傑作

masterful

adjective:

= 技巧高超、掌控力強的

Example:

> “It was a masterful performance.”

「那是一場**技巧高超的表演**。」

> “The performance was a masterpiece.”

「那場表演堪稱**傑作**。」

Related idea, different grammar.

AO. MASTERPIECE VS MASTERLY

41. **masterly = 大師級的；技藝高超的**

Practice 49

> “She gave a **masterly performance**.”

「她作出了一場**大師級的表演**。」

Practice 50

> “The argument was handled in a masterly way.”

「這個論點處理得**非常高明**。」

masterly describes exceptional skill.

masterpiece names the outstanding product/work.

AP. MASTERPIECE VS MASTERFUL — NUANCE

masterful

often emphasizes:

- * command
- * authority
- * control
- * skill

masterly

more directly:

- * exceptionally skillful

masterpiece

= the work/result itself.

Useful family distinction.

AQ. “ONE OF THE MASTERPIECES OF...”

42. **one of the masterpieces of + field/period =最傑出的作品之一**

Practice 51

> “It is one of the **masterpieces of modern cinema**.”

「它是**現代電影傑作之一**。」

Practice 52

> “The cathedral is one of the masterpieces of Gothic architecture.”

「這座大教堂是哥德式建築的**傑作之一**。」

AR. “A MASTERPIECE IN MINIATURE”

43. **a masterpiece in miniature = 小巧而完整的傑作**

A literary expression.

Practice 53

> “The short story is a **masterpiece in miniature**.”

「這篇短篇小說是一件**小巧而完整的傑作**。」

Practice 54

> “The tiny garden is a masterpiece in miniature.”

「這個小花園堪稱一件**袖珍傑作**。」

AS. “SELF-PROCLAIMED MASTERPIECE”

44. **self-proclaimed masterpiece = 自稱傑作的作品**

Often ironic.

Practice 55

> “He called his own film a **masterpiece**.”

「他把自己的電影稱作**傑作**。」

Practice 56

> “The self-proclaimed masterpiece received mixed reviews.”

「這部自稱為『**傑作**』的作品得到褒貶不一的評價。」

AT. "MASTERPIECE" AS HYPERBOLE

45. **masterpiece = exaggerated everyday praise — 神作；極佳之作**

Colloquial hyperbole.

Practice 57

> "That sandwich was a **masterpiece**."

「那份三文治簡直是**神作 / 做得太好了**。」

Practice 58

> "Your playlist is a masterpiece."

「你的歌單簡直是**神級作品**。」

Here it is figurative/hyperbolic:

> not necessarily formal artistic evaluation.

AU. "COMIC MASTERPIECE"

46. **comic masterpiece = 喜劇傑作**

Practice 59

> "The film is a **comic masterpiece**."

「這部電影是一部**喜劇傑作**。」

Practice 60

> "Critics called the episode a comic masterpiece."

「評論家稱這一集為**喜劇傑作**。」

AV. "TECHNICAL MASTERPIECE"

47. **technical masterpiece = 技術傑作**

Practice 61

> “The game is a **technical masterpiece**.”

「這款遊戲在技術上堪稱**傑作**。」

Practice 62

> “The building is a technical masterpiece despite its plain appearance.”

「儘管外觀樸素，這棟建築在技術上卻是**傑作**。」

AW. “VISUAL MASTERPIECE”

48. **visual masterpiece = 視覺傑作**

Practice 63

> “The film is a **visual masterpiece**.”

「這部電影是一部**視覺傑作**。」

Practice 64

> “The game was praised as a visual masterpiece.”

「這款遊戲被讚譽為**視覺上的傑作**。」

AX. “NARRATIVE MASTERPIECE”

49. **narrative masterpiece = 敘事傑作**

Practice 65

> “The novel is a **narrative masterpiece**.”

「這本小說是一部**敘事傑作**。」

Practice 66

> “Critics praised its structure as a narrative masterpiece.”

「評論家讚揚其結構，稱之為**敘事傑作**。」

AY. “MASTERPIECE” AND RELATIVE JUDGEMENT

A key semantic point:

****masterpiece is inherently evaluative.****

It does not simply describe:

- * size
- * popularity
- * fame
- * commercial success
- * technical correctness

It says:

> ****this work is judged to be exceptionally excellent****

So unlike ****video****, ****painting****, or ****novel****, which are neutral category words, ****masterpiece**** already contains strong praise.

AZ. “HARDLY” + MASTERPIECE

Your passage uses a particularly useful understatement:

> ****hardly a masterpiece****

This is stronger than simply:

> “not perfect”

It means:

> ****not remotely deserving the label ‘masterpiece’****

Natural Chinese:

* 遠稱不上傑作

- * 談不上甚麼傑作
- * 絕不是甚麼傑作

The writer is being modest and slightly humorous.

BA. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS

masterpiece vs hit

hit

= successful with the public.

masterpiece

= outstanding in quality.

Your source video:

> was a hit / viral success

but:

> hardly a masterpiece

That contrast is probably the single most important one for this passage.

masterpiece vs viral

viral

= spread rapidly.

masterpiece

= exceptionally good.

No necessary relationship.

masterpiece vs popular

popular

= liked by many people.

masterpiece

= judged outstanding.

A masterpiece can be unpopular at first.

A popular work can be mediocre.

masterpiece vs success

success

= achieves its goal.

masterpiece

= exceptionally high-quality work.

A social-media video can be enormously successful without being a masterpiece.

masterpiece vs achievement

achievement

= something difficult successfully accomplished.

masterpiece

= especially outstanding created work.

An achievement may be procedural or personal, not necessarily artistic.

masterpiece vs classic

classic

= established, enduring exemplary work.

masterpiece

= exceptional quality, even if new.

A newly released film may be called a masterpiece.

Calling it a classic usually implies broader long-term recognition.

masterpiece vs magnum opus

masterpiece

= any outstanding work.

magnum opus

= a creator's greatest or most important major work.

One artist may have several masterpieces but usually only one work commonly called their magnum opus.

masterpiece vs landmark work

landmark work

= historically influential/innovative.

masterpiece

= exceptionally excellent.

A work can be historically important without being aesthetically perfect, and vice versa.

masterpiece vs seminal work

seminal work

= highly influential in generating later ideas/developments.

masterpiece

= outstanding in quality.

Seminal emphasizes influence; **masterpiece** emphasizes excellence.

masterpiece vs chef-d'œuvre

chef-d'œuvre is a French-derived term meaning:

> masterpiece

It may appear in formal/artistic writing but is much less common in ordinary English.

masterpiece vs masterwork

masterwork

= close synonym, often formal.

masterpiece

= much more common in everyday English.

masterpiece vs masterpiece-level

Informal English can use:

> masterpiece-level animation

meaning:

> 達到傑作級水準的動畫

But this is a productive modifier, not a separate lexical meaning.

masterpiece vs masterpiece theatre/title names

Sometimes **Masterpiece** appears in names/titles of programmes, collections, brands, etc.

That is proper-name usage, not a separate lexical sense, so it should not be treated as core polysemy.

masterpiece in your passage

The passage says:

> “The video itself was hardly a **masterpiece**. It was a short, light-hearted clip...”

This sentence deliberately separates:

> **quality**

from:

> **viral success**

The writer means:

- * the video was simple
- * casually made
- * not artistically extraordinary
- * yet thousands of students found it relatable

So the lesson is:

> **something does not need to be a masterpiece to connect strongly with people.**

That is why the later sentence:

> “The happiest moment ... was creating something honest that others connected with.”

matters so much.

Family-extension sweep

Following the fullest-reference style, the useful modern inventory includes:

* **masterpiece — art** = 藝術傑作
 * **literary masterpiece** = 文學傑作
 * **musical masterpiece** = 音樂傑作
 * **cinematic masterpiece** = 電影傑作
 * **architectural masterpiece** = 建築傑作
 * **masterpiece of craftsmanship** = 工藝傑作
 * **masterpiece of engineering** = 工程傑作
 * **someone's masterpiece** = 某人的代表性最高傑作
 * **masterpiece — figurative strategy/design** = 高明之作 / 傑出成果
 * **culinary masterpiece** = 烹飪傑作
 * **design masterpiece** = 設計傑作
 * **technical masterpiece** = 技術傑作
 * **visual masterpiece** = 視覺傑作
 * **narrative masterpiece** = 敘事傑作
 * **hardly a masterpiece** = 遠稱不上傑作
 * **no masterpiece** = 並非甚麼傑作
 * **not exactly a masterpiece** = 談不上出色
 * **minor masterpiece** = 小型 / 小品傑作
 * **modern masterpiece** = 現代傑作
 * **acknowledged masterpiece** = 公認傑作
 * **lost masterpiece** = 失傳 / 遺失傑作
 * **masterpiece — historical guild sense** = 證明已達大師技藝的考核作品
 * **masterwork** = 傑作 / 大師之作
 * **magnum opus** = 畢生代表作
 * **masterpiece in miniature** = 袖珍 / 小巧傑作
 * **masterpiece — sarcastic** = 反諷式「傑作」
 * **masterpiece — hyperbolic** = 神作 / 極佳之作

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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masterpiece — general	在藝術、創作、設計或技藝上達到極高水準的傑出作品
literary masterpiece	文學價值和完成度極高的作品
musical masterpiece	作曲 / 音樂創作水準極高的作品
cinematic masterpiece	電影藝術 / 製作水準被認為極高的作品
architectural masterpiece	建築設計與完成度極出色的作品
masterpiece of craftsmanship	在製作技藝 / 工藝上達到極高水準的成果
someone's masterpiece	某位創作者最重要、最傑出作品之一
masterpiece — figurative	計劃、策略、工程、設計等做得極其高明的成果
hardly a masterpiece	明確表示某作品遠未達到傑作級水準
no masterpiece	雖可接受，但不應被視為特別傑出的作品
minor masterpiece	規模 / 地位較小但品質極高的作品

masterpiece — sarcastic	反諷地把糟糕成果稱為「傑作」	
masterpiece — historical	工匠用來證明自己已達師傅 / 大師級資格的作品	
masterwork	較正式的「傑作 / 大師之作」	
magnum opus	某創作者最重要、最具代表性的畢生大作	
masterpiece in miniature	規模很小但完成度極高的作品	

For your original sentence

> “The video itself was hardly a ****masterpiece****.”

The exact meaning is:

****masterpiece = 藝術 / 創作水準極高的傑作；而 hardly a masterpiece 表示作者認為自己的影片只是簡單、隨意、輕鬆的作品，完全談不上甚麼藝術傑作。 ****

Natural translation:

> ****「那段影片本身其實遠稱不上甚麼傑作。」 ****

or more conversationally:

> ****「那段影片本身其實沒甚麼了不起，根本談不上是傑作。」 ****

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****masterpiece**** → 傑作
- > ****someone's masterpiece**** → 某人的代表性最高傑作
- > ****masterpiece of engineering**** → 工程傑作
- > ****hardly a masterpiece**** → 遠稱不上傑作
- > ****minor masterpiece**** → 小品傑作
- > ****masterwork**** → 傑作 / 大師之作
- > ****magnum opus**** → 畢生代表作
- > ****masterpiece vs hit**** → 傑作 ≠ 熱門成功作品
- > ****masterpiece vs viral**** → 高品質 ≠ 爆紅
- > ****masterpiece vs popular**** → 傑出品質 ≠ 受歡迎程度
- > ****masterpiece vs classic**** → 傑作 ≠ 經時間驗證的經典
- > ****masterpiece vs success**** → 品質極高 ≠ 只是達成目標
- > ****masterpiece vs creation**** → 傑作 ≠ 一般創作作品